



Google buys \$1 billion plot

For its new headquarters in the UK, Google purchased a 2.4-acre plot in central London for a whopping sum of \$1 billion <http://dgit.in/VjHTLk>



Intel's birthday gift

Intel gifted legendary physicist Stephen Hawking a specially inscribed 300mm Silicon Wafer on his 70th birthday

Panasonic's Tablets – The Japanese giant unveiled a bevy of tablet devices across platforms at CES 2013, with a prototype 20-inch 4K Windows 8 tablet, and two production ready Toughpads, the FZ-G1 for Windows 8 Pro (due in March), and JT-B1 for Android 4.0 ICS (due in Feb), which can be immersed in water. The Panasonic FZ-G1



Toughpad (\$2,899) runs a 3rd Generation Intel Core i5-3437U vPro clocked at 1.9GHz up to 2.9GHz with Intel Turbo Boost Technology. It has a 1920x1200 pixel resolution display, a 128-256GB SSD, 4 to 8GB RAM, and an 8 hour battery life. The Panasonic Toughpad JT-B1 (\$1,199) has a TI OMAP4460 1.5GHz dual-core processor, 16GB of ROM, 1GB of RAM, 7-inches 500nit 1024 x 600 pixel display, and 8.0 hours battery life.

Lenovo IdeaCentre Horizon Table PC – A 27-inch all-in-one desktop PC, the IdeaCentre Horizon Table PC was designed with around-the-house portability, and a multi-user usage scenario in mind. The IdeaCentre Horizonsports a 27-inch 1,920 by 1,080 resolution screen, up to a Core i7 CPU, a choice of SSDs, and up to an Nvidia GeForce GT620M graphics. Untethered battery life is supposed to be two hours. It is exceptionally heavy, at 18



pounds, so definitely not portable, yet can serve from room to room. The AIO features the touch-optimized Aura interface that automatically comes up when you drop the screen to a horizontal position. The IdeaCentre Horizon is expected to start at \$1,699 and be available in early summer.

LG High-Resolution Mobile Displays

– Apart from the 4K and OLED TV shenanigans that have plagued CES 2013, we saw some interesting mobile device displays from LG at the event. The high resolution displays shown off by LG include a 12.9-inch display with



a resolution of 2560 x 1700. LG also showed off a 7-inch display with a 1920x1200 resolution, and a 5.5-inch 1920x1080 resolution display. All three are made using AH-IPS, a screen technology we have seen on the iPhone and iPad displays.

Kingston 1TB Flash Drive – At CES 2013, Kingston unveiled the HyperX Predator flash drive, with a whopping 1 terabyte of data storage capacity. The wow factor doesn't just stop at its mind-boggling storage capacity. What makes us sit up and take notice of the Kingston HyperX Predator 1TB (DTHXP30/1T) flash drive is its claim of near-SSD data transfer speeds. As the Kingston 1TB flash drive supports USB 3.0, it's claiming to deliver data transfer speeds of up to 240MB/s and 160



MB/s for read and write tasks, respectively. The Kingston HyperX Predator flash drive is housed in a zinc alloy casing that is highly shock-resistant. It is slated to arrive later in Q1 2013, with a bank-shattering US \$1,750 price!

Pebble Watch – One of the most exciting accessories to come out CES 2013, a gadget in its own right, was the Pebble watch. It features an e-paper (backlit at night) display and buttons that act as a control and notification interface for iPhone and Android devices, using Bluetooth for connectivity. It can also be used as a bike computer and pedometer. The Pebble works with iPhone 3GS, 4, 4S, 5 or any iPod Touch with iOS 5 or iOS 6 and Android devices running OS 2.3. Battery



life is supposedly over 7 days. It is designed to fit most 22mm watch bands, and is available for pre-order at \$150.

ViewSonic VS240 Smart Display – Viewsonic has shown off a 24-inch, 1080p HD touchscreen that runs Android 4.1 Jelly Bean, called the VSD240 Smart Display. It is expected to hit store shelves by April. The touchscreen also includes USB ports for hooking up a keyboard and mouse. Under the hood, a Tegra 3 processor powers the device. ViewSonic has speci-

fied that users can connect a Windows 8 computer in order to take advantage of Microsoft's Windows 8 touchscreen capabilities. The tablet is expected to launch later this year and will be priced at \$499. ViewSonic also showed off a prototype 32-inch 4K monitor, which is expected to hit store shelves by the end of the year.



Olympus STYLUS TOUGH TG-2 iHS

– Olympus unveiled three tough cameras at CES 2013, the most notable of which was the TG-2, the updated version of the company's popular TG-1. While the TG-2 retains the TG-1's 12 megapixel BSI-CMOS sensor and the f/2.0 lens, it is more rugged, and features a microscopic macro mode. The lens has a starting aperture of f/2.0 which goes all the way to f/4.9 through the zoom range of 25-100mm, but the lens comes with an adapter ring for more attachments. The camera can be taken up to 50 feet deep under water and can withstand drops from heights of upto 6 feet. The ruggedized



body also serves to protect the TG-2 against the elements and freezing temperatures as low as -10 Celsius wouldn't have any effect on the camera. 